

FOUNDATIONS OF MANAGEMENT

MODULE 1: LEARNING OBJECTIVES

The Value of Studying Management

➤ **The universality of management**

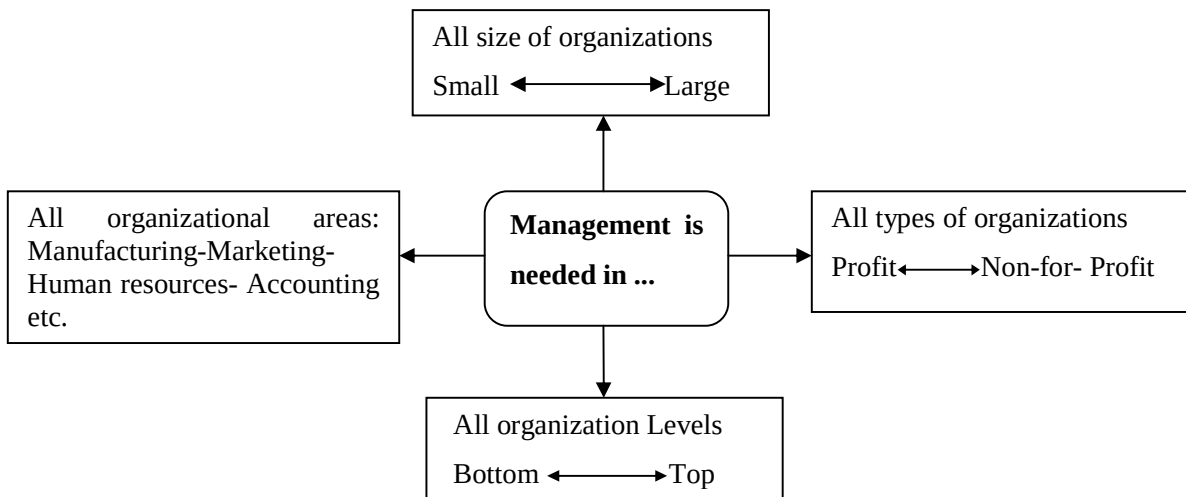
- ❖ Good management is needed in all organizations.

➤ **The reality of work**

- ❖ Employees either manage or are managed.

➤ **Rewards and challenges of being a manager**

- ❖ Management offers challenging, exciting and creative opportunities for meaningful and fulfilling work.
- ❖ Successful managers receive significant monetary rewards for their efforts.



Learning Objectives of studying management

1. **Getting Maximum Results with Minimum Efforts** - The main objective of management is to secure maximum outputs with minimum efforts & resources. Management is basically concerned with thinking & utilizing human, material & financial resources in such a manner that would result in best combination. This combination results in reduction of various costs.
2. **Increasing the Efficiency of factors of Production** - Through proper utilization of various factors of production, their efficiency can be increased to a great extent which can be obtained by reducing spoilage, wastages and breakage of all kinds, this in turn leads to saving of time, effort and money which is essential for the growth & prosperity of the enterprise.
3. **Maximum Prosperity for Employer & Employees** - Management ensures smooth and coordinated functioning of the enterprise. This in turn helps in providing maximum benefits to the employee in the shape of good working condition, suitable wage system, incentive plans on the one hand and higher profits to the employer on the other hand.
4. **Human betterment & Social Justice** - Management serves as a tool for the upliftment as well as betterment of the society. Through increased productivity & employment, management ensures better standards of living for the society. It provides justice through its uniform policies.

Introductory Caselets

The following mini caselets analysis activities are meant to reinforce concepts and to make the learning joyful. They also aim to give pupils simulated experiences of the managerial activities relevant to their level of understanding.

Caselet1: Company X is facing a lot of problems these days. It manufactures white goods like washing machines, microwave ovens, refrigerators and air conditioners. The company's margins are under pressure and the profits and market share are declining. The production department blames marketing for not meeting sales targets and marketing blames production department for

producing goods, which are not of good quality meeting customers' expectations. The finance department blames both production and marketing for declining return on investment and bad marketing. What quality of management do you think the company is lacking? Explain briefly. What steps should the company management take to bring the company back on track?

Caselet2: A company wants to modify its existing product in the market due to decreasing sales. You can imagine any product about which you are familiar. What decisions/steps should each level of management take to give effect to this decision?

Caselet3: A firm plans in advance and has a sound organization structure with efficient supervisory staff and control system. On several occasion it finds that plans are not being adhered to. It leads to confusion and duplication of work. Advise remedy.